

MARTA KOSTYUK

No. 11



Marta Kostyuk's impressive 2026 record speaks for itself. She reached the Roland Garros and Wimbledon semifinals and won tournaments in Madrid and Rouen.

Along the way, the hard-hitter from Ukraine defeated Pegula (twice), Andreeva (thrice), Swiatek, Noskova, Svitolina, and Anisimova. Much like Svitolina, her BJK Cup teammate, Kostyuk has passionately supported her war-ravaged homeland since the 2022 Russian invasion.

At Wimbledon, Sam Querrey praised the superbly fit, 5ft 9in Kostyuk as "a phenomenal athlete. She's so balanced on clay and grass." Possessing all the shots and a newfound calmness, she'll show the same talent and determination on the hard courts at Flushing Meadows — and show off her signature backflips that celebrate big wins.

Prediction: Quarterfinals

Pics: GETTY IMAGES

As a 15-year-old Russian prodigy in 2023, Alina Korneeva won junior Slam titles at the Australian Open, beating Andreeva in the final, and the French Open to earn the No. 1 world ranking. Her pro career was derailed by a wrist tendon injury and subsequent surgery in 2024, followed by an adductor injury last year. Ranked a misleading No. 89 before the Canadian Open, she qualified and then displayed her superior athleticism and versatile power game to outclass No. 23 Emma Navarro 6-2, 6-2 and No. 13 Iva Jovic 6-3, 6-4.

After the more experienced Gauff played superbly to defeat her 6-3, 6-1 in the fourth round, the American accurately assessed Korneeva. "She gets a lot of [serve] returns back. Kind of reminds me of Jess [Pegula], just how much consistency she has with the return," said Gauff. "Then also her demeanour. I didn't see her get upset at all, even maybe when she wasn't playing great at some moments. Also, she's a pretty good mover, she can get to a lot of balls. She has good hands. She likes to come forward. So, there are a lot of things she does well on the court, and she will definitely be someone that would be a threat to me and other players in the future."

Make that the very near future!

Prediction: Quarterfinals

No. 75

ALINA KORNEEVA

